

Why Earth is Special :

- It is present in habitable zone (range of distances from a star over which water can remain in a liquid state). Habitable zone is also called Goldilocks zone. If it was closer to Sun, then it would have been too hot or vice versa.
- Earth is the right size for sustaining life. This size allows it to have the gravity which holds our atmosphere & allows survival.
- Magnetic field is also an important factor as it protects us from high-speed energy particles coming & hitting Earth from space called cosmic rays. It also protects us from solar winds. These particles can harm life by letting UV rays in atmosphere & destroying ozone layer.
- Oxygen is also important because it allows respiration in organisms & combustion on Earth. But, there is a 3 atom oxygen

molecule which serves to protect us from harmful UV rays. That particle is known as Ozone (O_3)

Why Venus is the most hot?

- Mercury is the closest to Sun but Venus is the most hot, this is because atmosphere of Venus consists mostly of CO_2 which does not let heat escape & keeps the planet hot. This effect is known as Greenhouse effect

- Greenhouse effect is present on Earth too. Though CO_2 in Earth's atmosphere constitute to 0.04% only, the heat ~~trap~~ trapped by the ~~effect~~ effect is enough to keep Earth habitable & water in liquid state.

Why Mars?

- For scientists, Mars has been a important & interesting topic as it lies just at the edge of Sun's habitable zone but has no traces of life. But, scientists think that in the past, there may have been source of liquid water &

Conditions supporting life.

- ISRO also launched a satellite for exploring Mars called Mangalyaan in 2013. It was a smart & low cost tech. satellite made for ~~res~~ research on Mars.

// Hydrosphere ← Spheres →

Refers to the water covering 70% of Earth present in diff. water bodies. It is important for plants, marine life & humans. It is also important for evolution. It influence life on land too.

Geosphere

The ~~set~~ solid part of Earth consisting of soil, rocks & minerals is called geosphere. Crust, mantle & core, all are a part of this. Soil is rich in nutrients (nitrogen & potassium) & is suitable for ~~farm~~ farming.

Biosphere

The zone of Earth where air, land & water interact with each other to make life possible. All living beings live in this zone & ecosystems're a unit of this.

#

Diversity

Geodiversity



The variety of landforms, Earth's rocks, minerals, soil & geological processes is known as Geodiversity.

Biodiversity



Variety of living organisms, species, genes & ecosystem found on Earth.

// Ecological balance is the stable interaction b/w living organisms & environment. It's important because everything depends on environment & disruption in this balance can cause big problems like loss of biodiversity & climate change.

// Reproduction

• Reproduction is the process that ensure continuity of existence of each type of organism & life on Earth.

↳ Genes : Genetic materials or genes ^{is} ~~are~~ the substances which store & pass biological info. from generation to another. More specifically, gene is a segment of DNA (Genetic material).

Asexual reproduction

1) Requires only 1 parent

2) The offspring is identical to the parent.

3) Asexual reproduction can be divided into:

- 1) Vegetative propagation (Eg - Potato)
- 2) Budding (Eg - Yeast)
- 3) Fragmentation (Eg - Spirogyra)
- 4) Spores (Eg - Fern)
- 5) Binary Fission (Eg - Bacteria)

Sexual reproduction

Requires 2 parents.

The offspring might have feature similar to parents, but is not identical to them.

In this two parents are involved called male & female. Both release ~~sp~~ spl. cells called gametes (male = sperm; female = egg) which fuse together to form a zygote (fertilized cell capable of starting a new life). Gametes carry chromosomes (genetic info.).

In Depth: Sexual Reproduction

- Both gametes have 23 chromosomes each & get mixed to give the off-spring a unique set of features.
- We know pollination, let's study what happens after that. The pollen grain releases male gametes that fuse with female gamete to form zygote, this process is called fertilization & as the zygote develops, the ovary becomes the fruit. Agent that helped in pollination, can help in seed dispersal also.
- Aquatic animals (except dolphin) reproduce by first releasing sperm & egg in water, & when both gametes combine, they form zygote which turns ~~in~~ into embryos in water too.
- In birds & mammals, zygote formation has the same process, sperm is deposited inside the body of female & the sperm swims towards the egg, & forms zygote.

- In most mammals, embryo growth happens inside mother's body. Embryo takes all O_2 & nutrient through mother's body. This duration is usually called pregnancy. But, in bird, mother usually lays an egg which has zygote & all the food needed for growing baby bird is already present in the egg.

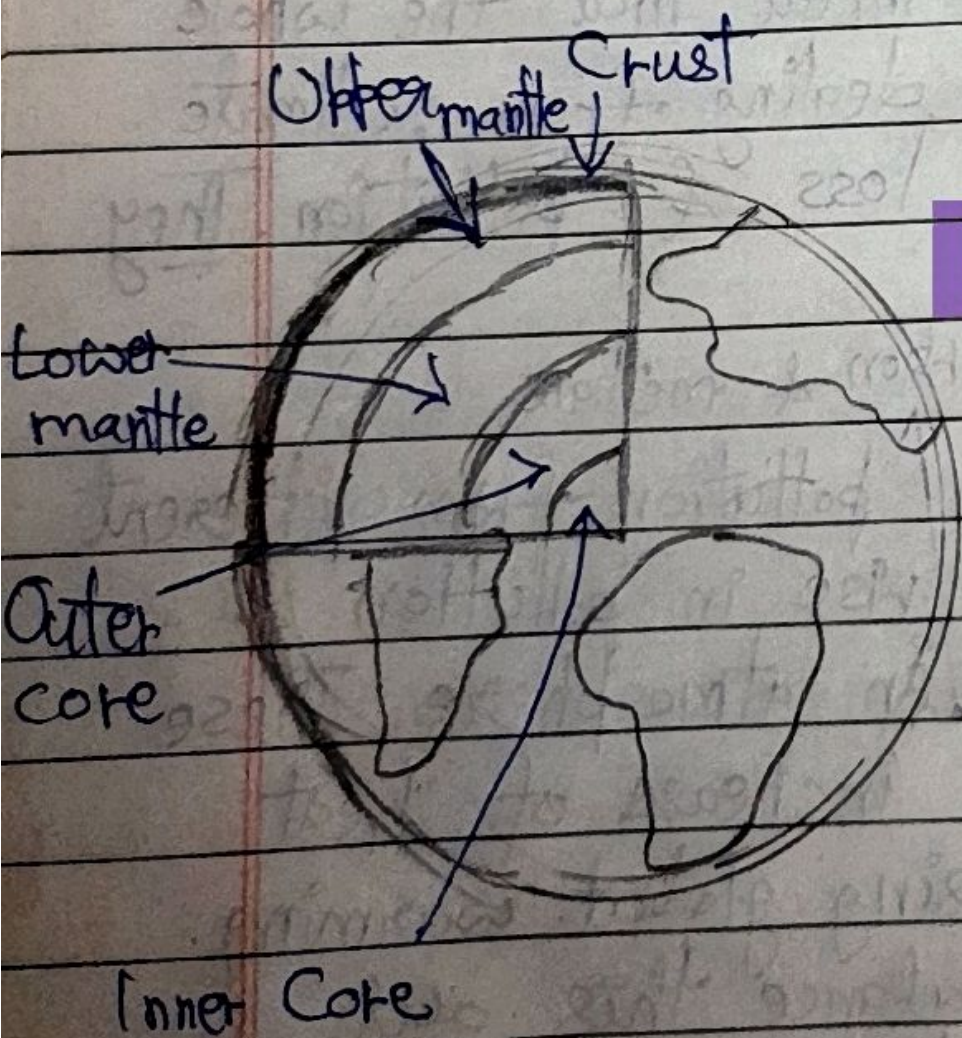
Threats to Life

- There are 3 major threat that the whole world is currently dealing from: climate change, biodiversity loss & pollution. They all are interlinked

carbon & methane

- Burning fossil fuel & pollution from different industries cause a rise in pollution & increases ~~CFC~~ gases in atmosphere. These gases lead to the increase of heat being trapping causing global warming. Naturally Earth balance this out & absorbs CO_2 but these gases in excess & deforestation reduce this ability of Earth.

- Long-term changes in temp, rainfall & weather patterns is known as climate change. It also affects water supply, human health & wildlife habitat.
- Biodiversity is imp. because diverse ecosystems are stronger & more balanced.
- Everyone can help by simple preventive measures.
Eg- 3Rs



~~Fact~~ Fact

Though the core is very hot, metals there, exists in a solid state.